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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

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Place Coverage

Kade area, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S)

(1) Viewpoint and Method • SPATIAL PROXIMITY AND KINSHIP

SPATIAL PROXIMITY AND KINSHIP

(1) Viewpoint and Method

Kinship organization among the Central Kalahari San is undeveloped — ego applies kinship terminology towards kindreds vertically only within two generations both upward and downward, and laterally within the range of 1st cousins (Tanaka, 1980). Kindred is classified into dichotomous categories of joking and avoidance, and social behavior is differentiated into two systems in accordance with which category the other person belongs to.

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From the description by Tanaka (1980) and Silberbauer (1981) the principles for classifying kindreds into two categories of joking and avoidance can be summarized as follows:

- 1) Avoidance relationship is applied to the adjacent generation, except for mother's brother, father's sister, and their spouses.
- 2) Joking relationship is applied to the same generation, except siblings of the opposite sex, parallel cousin of the opposite sex, and their spouses.
- 3) Joking relationship is applied to the persons belonging to the alternate generations. Marshall (1976) reported that Nyae Nyae !Kung in Namibia have developed a specific system such as the homonymous method but have also described practically the same principle for the classification of joking-avoidance relationships as the Central Kalahari San do.

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I am not prepared to fundamentally reconsider the concept of the joking-avoidance relationship, important and prevalent within the discipline of social anthropology, from the perspective of bodily interaction. The only thing that I can do in this paper is to examine the correlation between the degree of proximity-contact and kinship relations among the Central Kalahari San. As a matter of course, the denotation of the concepts of 'joking' and 'avoidance', is the extent to which an individual can behave at will in a species-specific social interaction; that is, conversation. However, anthropologists often refer to the aspects of bodily interaction, such as physical contact, proximity, and gaze direction, which corresponds to either of 'joking' or 'avoidance' relationships (Marshall, 1976; Silberbauer, 1981; Matsuzono, 1981). This fact strongly suggests that such a dichotomous system might be, if it actually exists, based on very deep interpersonal attitudes unconsciously expressed at the level of bodily interaction. If so, this system is very likely to be reflected in the quantitative data of proxemics.

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In this section, the following 3 analysis methods are adopted:

1) It is examined whether proximity within 2 m or bodily contact were observed at least once during focal individual sampling throughout the research period for every possible dyad between all residents over pubescence in Camps V, VI, and VII. Next, these dyads are classified into kinship categories, and the difference in the number of dyads for which proximity or body contact were observed is statistically examined between kinship categories.

2) Similarly, the dyads of residents are classified into generational categories, and the difference in the number of dyads for which proximity or body contact were observed is statistically examined between generational categories.

3) Focal individuals who were observed for relatively long periods were selected. The individuals are listed as to who was in proximity or contact with focal individuals. Kinship relations between focal individuals and 'frequent neighbors' (i.e., those who were in conspicuously frequent proximity or contact with each focal individual) are examined. Thus the interindividual variation in the list of frequent neighbors is elucidated.

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In the following part, the dyads for which proximity within 2 m and body contact occurred at least once will be designated as the 'dyads in proximity' and the 'dyads in contact', respectively. The subject individuals of the  26 above analyses 1) and 2) includes 16 males and 16 females. One male residents (NS) and 2 female residents (ts-4 and kb-8) are excluded from the analysis, because these residents, frequently absent from their own camp because of visiting or traveling, were rarely observed.

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Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



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